

FIT College — Full URL Cutover Runbook

Old site: fitcollege.edu.au (legacy Kook CMS, ~95 sitemap URLs + long tail)

New site: 45-page rebuild (this repo) implemented on Kook CMS

Companion files: `redirect-map.csv` (110 mapped URLs) · `sitemap.xml` · `robots.txt` · `OLD-SITE-AUDIT.md`

Owner: Stanley (nothing goes live without sign-off) · **Implementer:** Kook

This is the launch-day playbook for cutting every old URL over to the new structure — including the **RPL/USI/About consolidation** (§5), the Study Online collapse, campaign retirements and campus retirements — without losing rankings, GBP traffic or live campaign spend.

Phase 0 — Go/No-Go gate (all must be YES before a date is set)

#	Gate	Source
0.1	All 108 [CONFIRM] chips resolved (NAP, timetables, course details, CEC size, CRICOS)	README / audit §Part 2.1
0.2	Verbatim legal copy DONE 6 Jul 2026 — pasted verbatim from live PrivacyPolicy-360 / TermsOfUse-361	audit §1-G
0.3	Current handbook DONE 6 Jul 2026 — links current v3.6 handbook + 6-policy library from PoliciesandProcedures-516; carry <code>/userfiles/</code> PDFs over unchanged	<code>student-handbook.html</code>
0.4	Career Start figures re-verified against official QLD Government source	README
0.5	<code>.img-slot</code> placeholders replaced with Damian's photography	README
0.6	Eligibility checker mapped to HubSpot properties; SMS speed-to-lead tested end-to-end	<code>funding.html</code> comments
0.7	No live paid campaigns pointing at pages being retired (check ad accounts vs audit §1-D)	marketing
0.8	GSC reconciliation CLOSED per Stanley — index-probe audit accepted as final; Phase 3 log-watching is the safety net for unmapped long-tail URLs	audit §Part 2.3
0.9	Stanley's sign-off	—

Phase 1 — T-minus 1 week (prep, zero user impact)

- **Freeze old-site content.** No new pages, promos or URL changes on the legacy CMS after this point — the redirect map is built against a snapshot.
- **Full backup/export** of the legacy CMS (pages + `/userfiles/` PDFs).
- **Load `redirect-map.csv` into Kook's redirect engine** on staging. Rules:
 - All redirects are **server-side 301** (not meta-refresh, not JS).
 - Rows with `redirect_type=410` return **410 Gone** (retired backup form, Salesforce page, Slideshow widget).
 - Rows with empty `new_url` and `action=KEEP/NOINDEX` are **not redirected** — they stay live (Staff Lead Form, Affiliatedeal, audit info, `/userfiles/` current PDFs) with `noindex` where marked.
- Legacy CMS URLs are case-insensitive in the wild (`/Contact/` vs `/contact/`) — match **case-insensitively** and with/without trailing slash.
- **One hop only:** old URL → final URL. No chains (e.g. `/Study/AboutUs/RPL-478/` must go straight to `/about.html#rpl` , not via `/about-us`).
- **Crawl the staging site** (Screaming Frog or similar): 0 broken internal links, 1 `<title>` /OG set per page, header renders once, pinch-zoom enabled.
- **Verify GSC + GA4 + GBP access** for whoever runs post-launch monitoring; note baseline rankings for the top 20 queries.

Phase 2 — Launch day (in this order)

Step	Action	Verify	
2.1	Deploy the 45 new pages to production	spot-check 5 pages render	
2.2	Remove <code><meta name="robots" content="noindex, nofollow"></code> from all pages	<code>`curl -s <url> \</code>	<code>grep -c noindex` → 0</code>
2.3	Activate the full 301/410 ruleset from <code>redirect-map.csv</code>	run the smoke test below	
2.4	Deploy <code>robots.txt</code> (adds the previously missing <code>Sitemap:</code> line)	<code>curl https://www.fitcollege.edu.au/robots.txt</code>	
2.5	Deploy <code>sitemap.xml</code> (45 canonical URLs only — no legacy, no promo, no duplicates)	fetch + XML-validate	
2.6	Submit <code>sitemap.xml</code> in GSC; use URL Inspection → Request indexing on home, courses, funding, locations	GSC shows "Success"	
2.7	Update GBP website links for all 20 campuses to the new <code>location-*.html</code> URLs (from the NAP Master tab)	click each GBP link	
2.8	Update HubSpot forms/meeting links + SMS automation endpoints to new URLs; send one live test enquiry	SMS arrives < 5 min	
2.9	Repoint any live ad campaigns/bio links/email footers at new URLs	marketing checklist	

Redirect smoke test (run against production; every line must return `301` + the mapped target, per `redirect-map.csv`):

```
while IFS=, read -r old new type _; do
  [ "$type" = "301" ] || continue
  printf '%s -> ' "$old"
  curl -s -o /dev/null -w '%{http_code} %{redirect_url}\n' "https://www.fitcollege.edu.au${old%#*}"
done < redirect-map.csv
```

Priority spot-checks (highest-traffic/highest-risk):

`/Study/Funding-513/` → funding · `/Courses/Courses-482/` → courses · all 7 Study Online URLs → study-online · the 3 disability URLs → one course page · `/Study/AboutUs/RPL-478/` → `/about.html#rpl` · `/locations/hobart-city-centre` → hobart-aquatic-centre.

Phase 3 — T-plus monitoring

- **Day 1–3 (daily):** GSC Coverage for spikes in 404s; server logs for unmapped legacy URLs → add rows to `redirect-map.csv` and redeploy; confirm forms + SMS still firing.
- **Week 1–2:** GSC "Pages → Not indexed" — retired campaign/duplicate URLs should move to "Page with redirect"; new pages should begin indexing. Re-request indexing for stragglers.
- **Week 2–6 (weekly):** rank tracking vs the Phase 1 baseline. A temporary wobble is normal; sustained drops on money pages (funding, cert-iii, cert-iv, fit-elite) → check the redirect for that page first.
- **Keep 301s live ≥ 12 months** (permanently is fine — they're one config file). Never recycle a retired URL for new content.

Rollback (if the site is materially broken at launch)

- Re-point DNS/CMS to the legacy snapshot (Phase 1 backup).
- **Do NOT leave the new `sitemap.xml` submitted** while rolled back — remove it in GSC.
- Root-cause, fix on staging, re-run Phase 2 from step 2.1. Redirect config is additive, so a re-launch reuses the same tested ruleset.

§5 — RPL / USI / About consolidation cutover (detail)

The rebuild collapses the old About cluster into a single `about.html` with

in-page anchors (`#rpl` , `#usi` — added to the page for this cutover):

Old URL	New target	Notes
/Study/AboutUs-446/	/about.html	main About page
/about-us	/about.html	clean-URL duplicate of the same page
/Study/AboutUs/RPL-478/	/about.html#rpl	RPL section anchor
/Study/AboutUs-446/RPL-478/	/about.html#rpl	RPL path variant (both live URLs confirmed indexed)
/Study/AboutUs/USIUniqueStudentIdentifier-475/	/about.html#usi	USI section anchor
/Study/AboutUs-446/USIUniqueStudentIdentifier-475/	/about.html#usi	USI path variant
/Study/AboutUs-446/FAQs-474/	/faqs.html	FAQ content moved to the FAQ page, not About

Cutover notes:

- Fragments (#rpl) survive a 301 in every major browser — the server sends

Location: /about.html#rpl and the browser scrolls to the section.

- **Content parity check before launch:** the old RPL page describes the

evidence-portfolio process in more depth than the current about.html

summary. Since GSC reconciliation was dropped (gate 0.8), assume the RPL

page has organic entrances and expand the #rpl section to match intent —

a 301 onto thinner content is how consolidations leak rankings.

- The Student Handbook also covers RPL — student-handbook.html and

about.html#rpl cross-link (already wired).

- RPL enquiries route to the Career Advisor CTA (no separate RPL form in the

rebuild) — confirm HubSpot tags these so the course team still sees them.

Deliberately NOT redirected (decision record)

- **KEEP live:** /staffleadform (+ /Contact/StaffLeadForm-597/) staff referral form (noindex) · /Study/AuditInformation-574/ · current /userfiles/ PDFs (carry over unchanged — 7 current policy PDFs are linked from student-handbook.html) · blog.fitcollege.edu.au (HubSpot — footer-linked, untouched by this cutover)
- **Migrated:** /Affiliatedeal → affiliate-deal.html (built; excluded from sitemap.xml — partner-link entry only)
- **410 Gone:** /Contact/RequestanInfoPack(backup)-659/ · /Study/Salesforce-627/ · /Contact/Slideshow-363/
- **Retired (decided 6 Jul 2026):** /BecomeaPersonalTrainer/FITCollegeInsurance-603/ → 301 to faqs.html · stale 2019 handbook PDF → 301 to student-handbook.html
- **All decisions closed — no open items remain in this runbook.**